

HaiCo platform — IT questions, and how I answer them

Short, plain answers for the questions IT and the managers are likely to ask about the demo. The demo is a working model of the design; the live system is built on the same rules.

Demo: Netlify site · fictional data
Review route and demo PDFs in the docs folder

WHAT IT IS

What am I looking at — is this the real system?

It's a working demo. Every screen, approval step and rule behaves the way the live system will, but it runs in the browser with fictional people and figures so we can test the process before anything is built for real.

Where does the data live right now?

Only in the browser of the person using the demo. Nothing is sent anywhere. Refreshing the demo resets it to the starting data. The live system keeps everything in a database on our side.

Why one web page? Will the live system be like that?

For the demo, one file is the simplest thing to hand around and host. The live system is a normal web application: a database, a server that checks every action, and the screens you see here.

SECURITY AND ACCESS

How do people sign in?

With their work account. The demo uses a shared test password because the people are made up; the live system signs in through [Microsoft 365](#), so there is no separate password to manage and leavers lose access when their account is closed.

Who can see what?

Each person has a role — employee, manager, HR, Finance, executive, administrator. The role decides which menus they get, and the server checks the same rules again on every action, so hiding a button is never the only protection.

Are credit card numbers stored?

No. A credit card purchase records what was bought, who approved it and what Finance was charged. Card numbers, expiry dates and security codes are never entered, never stored and never emailed.

What about bank details for pay?

Finance holds them. Screens show masked values only, and the demo contains no real account numbers.

Is there an audit trail?

Yes. Every action — a request, an approval, a decline, a rate change, a stat holiday added — is written to the audit log with who did it and when. Financial and approval records are never deleted; they can only be cancelled or closed.

If I don't know: "That's an IT setup decision — I'll bring it to you with the options rather than guess." Hosting, backup schedule, and single sign-on setup are the three to hand to IT.

HOW IT WORKS

How does a request know who approves it?

From the organization chart. It goes to the person's supervisor. If that supervisor is on approved time off that day, it also goes to the next person up, and the first decision counts. Amounts over the limit add director level. Nobody approves their own request.

What happens if someone changes the rules — rates, limits?

Finance keeps the rates on one page. The Finance Manager changes them directly; anyone below sends a change for approval first. Every change is logged with the old and new values. Requests already sent keep the rates they were made with.

How does it connect to payroll and the ledger?

Approved timesheets feed the pay run; banked overtime is credited to time off instead of paid. Processed purchases and paid claims post to the general ledger with their account and department, so reports line up without re-keying.

RUNNING IT

Where will it be hosted? Who supports it?

The demo is on Netlify. The live system can run in our Microsoft 365 / Azure tenant or with a Canadian hosting provider — that's a decision for IT, and the design doesn't depend on it. Day-to-day support is the same as any internal web app: access requests through IT, process questions through Finance and HR.

Emails — are they real?

In the demo they are kept in an inbox panel so you can read them without anything being sent. In the live system the same messages go out through Microsoft 365, attachments included. The wording is editable by an administrator.

Backups and recovery?

The live system keeps a full history of every change, so any record can be traced back. Database backups follow IT's normal schedule for the chosen host.

Will it work on phones and tablets?

Yes — the screens adjust to the width. Timesheets and approvals work on a phone; the printed purchase order is sized for a page.

What if we want something changed?

Changes are collected on each page and built in rounds, with every change reviewed before it goes live. That is how the demo itself has been refined — the request centre, time off and the Finance pages all came from review notes.

Three things to repeat: no card numbers stored · the server checks every permission · nothing financial is ever deleted.